



Abhyasa and Vairagya

*"yogena chittasya padena vacham
malam sharirasya cha vaidyakena
yo'pakarottamam pravaram muninam
patanjalin pranjaliranato'smi"*

Abhyasa and Vairagya

I.14 *"Sa tu dirghakaala-nairantarya-satkaara-aadaradara-aasevito dridha-bhumi"*

"But it [abhyasa] is a solid foundation only if practiced with fervor, perseverance, uninterruptedly and for a long time."

I.15

"Drishta-anushravika-vishaya-vitrinshnasya vashikaara-samjnaa vairagyam"

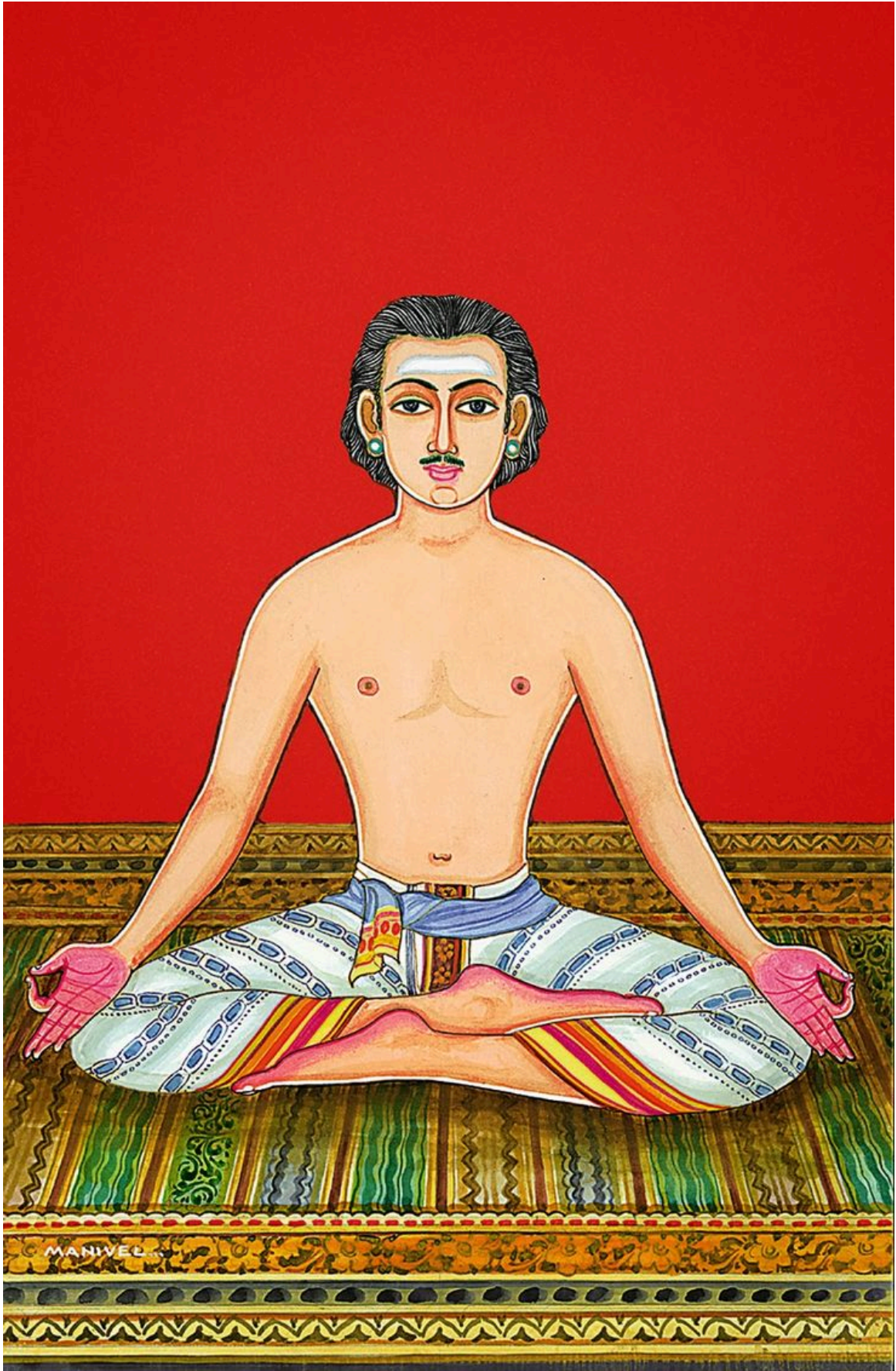
"Vairagya is the practice of detachment from desire."

In asana practice, Vairagya, or **letting go**, is accepting your lack of flexibility.

Letting go is accepting that the **perfect posture** is the one you can **no longer improve** with **your current means**.

In life, Vairagya means **accepting** what is, what happens, accepting the other in his or her difference, **without wanting him or her to be the same as you**, it means **loving without wanting to tie, identify or enslave**.

Letting go means no longer being driven by the desire to take, possess or control.



I.16 *"Tat-param Purusha-khyater guna-vaitrish-nyam"*

"The highest degree of letting go is detachment from the Gunas through Self-awareness."

We have seen that

the trigunas are the three primordial energies that make up all the elements of Prakriti. When we drink too much coffee, for example, we become too agitated, due to the excess of rajasic energy. **Detachment from trigunas** means **freeing ourselves** from the impact of trigunas on our reactions. So, in our example, if we practice detachment, we become aware of our excess rajas due to coffee and we can deal with our emotions by rebalancing our trigunas. In our case, this emotion is the stress caused by excess coffee.



"Accepting D.eath is the worthiest detachment, only if you let go your Fear of D.eath, you would be able to sense fully D.Force" Padawan Roronoa D.Zoro

The Kleshas

The Kleshas refer to afflictions and suffering. They can also be seen as the sources of suffering.

Patanjali lists 5 of them, which he discusses in sutra II.3.

II.3 "avidya asmita raga dvesa abhinivesah klesah"

"The causes of suffering blindness, the feeling of ego, the desire take, the refusal to accept, the attachment to life."

1. Avidya: ignorance.
2. Asmita: ego or pride. Example from Facebook.
3. Raga: attachment. Example of a mother too attached to her son.
4. Dvesa: aversion. Example of the spider.
5. Abhinivesah: Fear of death. Example of the plane.

Avidya: ignorance

"Ignorance is the source of all suffering. This is what sutra II.4 describes:

II.4 "avidya kshetram uttaresam prasupta tanu vicchinna udaranam"

"ignorance of reality is the source of other causes of suffering, whether developed, interrupted, attenuated or dormant."

avidya: ignorance, blindness

kshetram: field, place, seat

prasupta: asleep

tanu: small, light

vicchinna: momentarity interrupted

udara: important, developed

Vyasa, the historical commentator on the Yoga Sutra, compares ignorance to a field that provides the breeding ground for other four afflictions, namely egoism, desire, repulsion and fear of death.

Patanjali defines ignorance in sutra II.5:

II.5 "Anitya asuci duhkha anatmasu nitya suci sukha atma khyatih avidya"

"Ignorance of reality is mistaking the impermanent, the impure, the unhappy, that which is not the Self, for the permanent, the pure, the happy, the Self."

nitya-a-nitya: permanent impermanent

shuchi-a-shuchi: pure impure

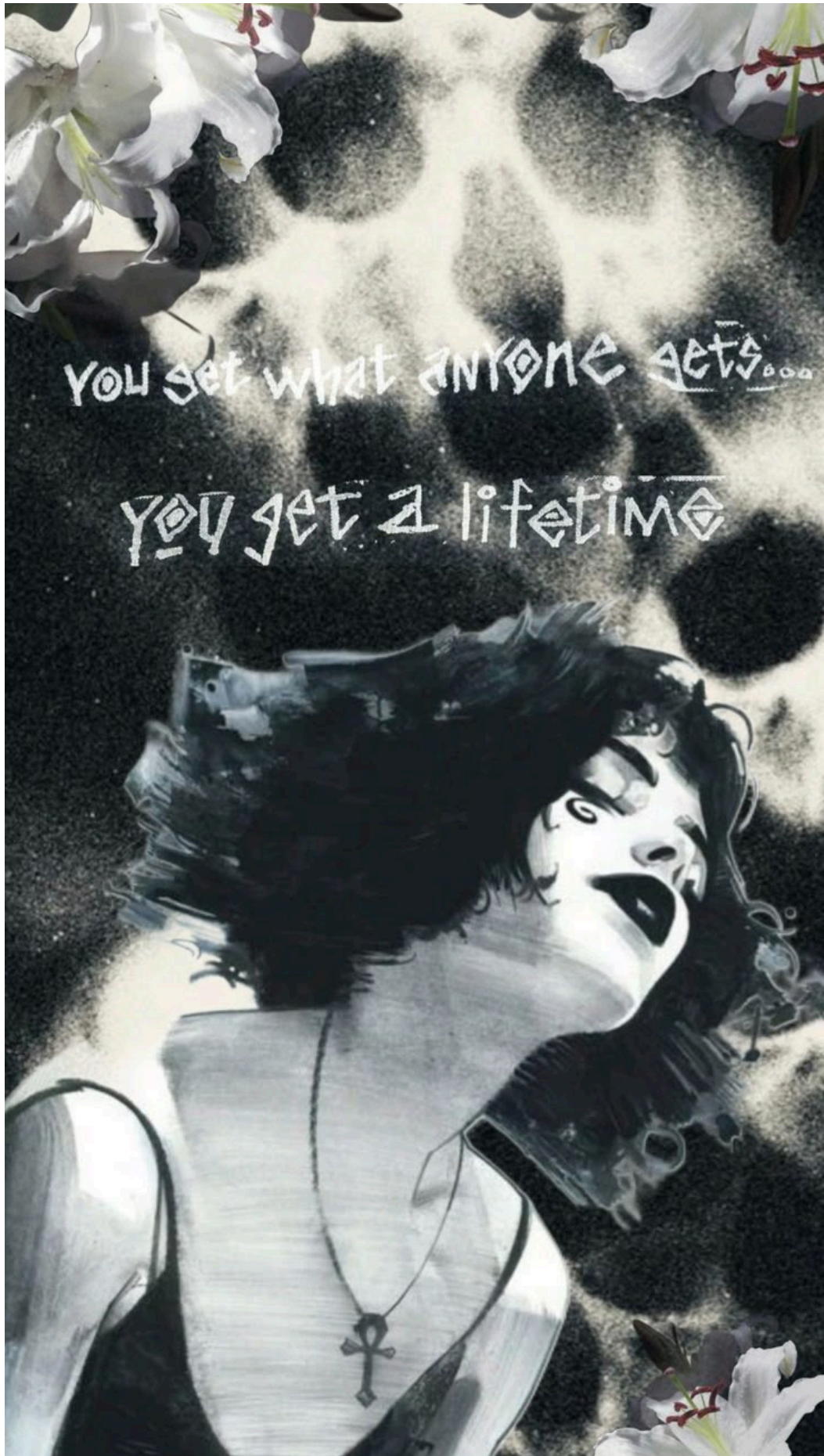
duhkha : misfortune

atman : the Self

sukha: happiness

khyati: awareness of, knowledge

avidya: ignorance, blindness



"Don't be afraid of me, I make very good cookies ;)" D.eath one of D.Eternal family.